

Informed Consent of Study Participation

You are invited to participate in the user study "Task Switching". The study is conducted by Gäbler Johannes, Kozhukhar Kseniia, Auer Celina Tanja, Khaium Md. Omar, and Zamani Sepehr and supervised by Prof. Pawel W. Wozniak from the Technischen Universität Wien. The study with estimated 20 participants takes place in the period from 2025-11-17 to 2025-12-08. Please note:

- Your participation is entirely voluntary and can be discontinued or withdrawn at any time
- One session of the user study will last ca. 45 minutes
- You have no direct benefit from participating in the study, but your support our work and help to advance research in this area
- For the evaluation, we collect some of personal information (e.g., age, gender, etc.)
- During the session, we will log your input and manually record notes
- Recordings and personal data are subject to the guidelines of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and will pseudoanonymized (with a coded number) stored, evaluated, and potentially published so that without information from the researchers no conclusions can be drawn about individual persons

The alternative to participation in this study is to choose not to participate. If you have any questions, concerns, or complaints about the informed consent process of this research study or your rights as a human research subject, please contact Prof. Pawel W. Wozniak. Please read the following information carefully and take the time you need.

1. Purpose and Goal of this Research

This study investigates how different work environments influence people's experience while completing multiple tasks. The goal is to understand how environmental factors affect comfort and task performance during multitasking. Your participation will help us achieve this research goal. The results of this research may be presented at scientific or professional meetings or published in scientific proceedings and journals.

2. Study Participation

Your participation in this user study is entirely voluntary and can be discontinued or withdrawn at any time. You can refuse to answer any questions or continue with the study at any time if you feel uncomfortable in any way. You can discontinue or withdraw your participation at any time without giving a reason. However, we reserve the right to exclude you from the study (e.g., with invalid trials or if continuing the study could have a negative impact on your well-being or the equipment). During your participation the house rules and hygiene regulations apply at the Technischen Universität Wien. Violations can mean the termination of the study. Repeated participation in the study is not permitted.

3. Study Procedure

After confirming this informed consent the procedure is as follows:

1. Participants get introduced to the study
2. Participants familiarize themselves with the task
3. Break
4. Participants complete the first iteration of the tasks and complete a questionnaire
5. Break
6. Participants complete the second iteration of the tasks and complete a questionnaire
7. Break
8. Participants engage in a brief interview

The confirmation of participation in this study can be obtained directly from the researchers.

4. Risks and Benefits

In the user study you will not be exposed to any immediate risk or danger. Discomfort or inconvenience are not likely to happen. If any discomforts become a problem for you, you should discontinue your participation immediately. If you are getting injured as a result of participating in the study, seek medical help if possible immediately and contact the principal investigator. Enrolled students are automatically insured against the consequences of accidents through statutory accident insurance and with private liability insurance in case of any damages at the Technischen Universität Wien. As with all computer systems on which data is processed, despite security measures, there is a small risk of data leakage and the loss of confidential or personal information. You have no direct benefit from participating in the study, but your support our work and help to advance research in this area.

5. Data Protection and Confidentiality

In this study, personal and personal data are collected for our research. The use of personal or subject-related information is governed by the European Union (EU) General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and will be treated in accordance with the GDPR. This means that you can view, correct, restrict processing, and delete the data collected in this study. Only with your agreement, we will log your input and manually record notes in the study. We plan to publish the results of this and other research studies in academic articles or other media. Your data will not be retained for longer than necessary or until you contact researchers to have your data destroyed or deleted. Access to the raw data, transcribed interviews, and observation protocols of the study is encrypted, password-protected and only accessible to the authors, colleagues and researchers collaborating on this research. Other members and administrators of our institution do not have access to your data. When publishing, the data will be anonymized using code numbers and published in aggregated form, so that without information from the researchers no conclusions can be drawn about individual persons. Any interview content or direct quotations from the interview, that are made available through academic publications or other academic outlets will also be anonymized using code numbers. Since no contact details (e.g. emails) are collected, the researchers cannot inform the participants about further details of the study or about a possible breach of confidential data.

6. Identification of Investigators

If you have any questions or concerns about the research, please feel free to contact:

Researchers

Gäbler Johannes (e11701290@student.tuwien.ac.at)
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Principal investigator

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7. Informed Consent and Agreement

This consent form will be retained securely and in compliance with the GDPR for no longer than necessary.

- ☐ I understand the explanation of the user study provided to me and I voluntarily agree to participate in this user study. I have had all my questions answered to my satisfaction and I am aware of risks and benefits. I understand that this declaration of consent is revocable at any time. I can obtain a copy of this consent form upon request.
- ☐ I agree that the researchers will record the above mentioned data during the user study. I understand that all data will be treated confidentially and in compliance with the GDPR. I understand that the material will be anonymized via codes and cannot be directly associated with my identity. I understand that full anonymity cannot be guaranteed and a breach of confidentiality is always possible. From the consent of publication, I cannot derive any rights (such as any explicit acknowledgment, financial benefit, or co-authorship).

Location, Date

Printed Name of Subject

Signature of Subject